



1st Grade Strive Academy Blueprint

Launch Cadet | Adaptive Learning Protocol Conversion

This document converts the source grade curriculum into a Strive Academy operating blueprint: integrated missions, 4MAT learning, retrieval practice, variable learning modes, mastery checks, and Mind Palace reflection.

Core Operating Idea	Students do not just finish assignments. They prove mastery, reflect, improve, and apply knowledge in real life.
Grade Role	Launch Cadet
Primary Use	Teacher planning, parent transparency, AI lesson generation, weekly mission mapping, and student support.

1. Source Curriculum Snapshot

Source file: 1st-Grade-Curriculum-Transparency.pdf

Core Knowledge/Utah standards, Shurley Method Level 1, Heggerty phonemic awareness, classic literature and fairy tales, Language for Thinking, music and poetry, sayings and phrases, science topics, Spalding spelling, Adventures in Language writing, conceptual math, Reading Mastery/Take Flight, and CMC/Saxon math placement.

Strive does not throw away the curriculum. It turns it into a better delivery system. Same academic spine; stronger mission framing, mastery feedback, project application, and reflection.

Core Subject Translation

Strive Module	Source Curriculum Content / Grade Focus
Reading Quest	Core Knowledge stories, fairy tales, fables, Anansi, Brer Rabbit, Hansel and Gretel, Jack and the Beanstalk, Peter Rabbit, drama, oral retell, fluency
Word Lab	Heggerty phonemic awareness, Shurley grammar level 1, Spalding spelling, sayings and phrases
Math Arena	Patterns/classifications, number sense, computation, money, geometry, measurement
Science Bay	Living things, habitats, helping habitats, oceans, body systems, germs, matter, electricity, measurement, astronomy, Earth
History Expedition	Communities, Ice Age, Mesopotamia, Ancient Egypt, world religions, early civilizations, English settlers, American Revolution, symbols, American West, Mexico
Logic Deck	Language for Thinking, compare/contrast, sequence, cause/effect, oral reasoning
Music/Art Flight	Melody, rhythm, Mozart, instruments, orchestra, music as story, folk/patriotic songs, Core Knowledge art

2. Strive Protocol Applied to This Grade

Protocol	Classroom Meaning
S - Stack Functions	Connect reading, vocabulary, geography, science, writing, art, music, and character through one shared mission theme.
T - Teach through 4MAT	Every lesson moves through WHY, WHAT, HOW, WHAT IF, then a mastery check.
R - Retrieval + Spacing	Daily flashback questions, oral retell, speed reads, flashcards, and cumulative reviews.
I - Integrated Learning Paths	Units become missions; each subject studies the same world from a different lens.
V - Variable Modes	Visual, audio, hands-on, conversational, simplified, and challenge modes for ADHD, autism, dyslexia, and advanced learners.
E - Evaluate & Evolve	Mastery scores, reflection, and kaizen improvements decide what changes next week.

The goal is simple: every subject helps another subject. Reading strengthens science. History strengthens vocabulary. Math appears inside maps, experiments, songs, and builds. Worksheets stop wandering around like lost cows.

3. Daily Cadence and Learning Architecture

The grade day should be run as a repeatable operating system. First graders need rhythm, story, movement, and quick wins.

Block	Time	Purpose	Strive Output
Launch Briefing	5 min	Mission theme, virtue, big question	Student can say why the mission matters
Core Academic Rotations	90-120 min	Reading, math, writing, science/history, word lab	Micro-lessons with 80-90% mastery target
Retrieval Loop	10-15 min	Review yesterday, last week, and last month	Flashcards, oral recall, speed read
Applied Mission Lab	30-60 min	Hands-on project, map, model, art, song, experiment	Evidence of doing, not just hearing
Mind Palace Debrief	5-10 min	Reflection, emotion, effort, courage, mistake learned	Per-lesson or daily mission report

Weekly Flow

- Monday: mission launch, vocabulary pre-load, big question, first WHY/WHAT lesson.
- Tuesday-Wednesday: deep practice, integrated reading/math/science/history tasks, retrieval from prior lessons.
- Thursday: project build, writing/drawing draft, oral retell, and teach-back rehearsal.
- Friday: mastery check, mission report, portfolio artifact, and kaizen debrief.

4. Mission Report Integration

Use the per-lesson Mission Report orally, pictorially, or in short writing. Use the Weekly Mission Report for parent/mentor visibility. For first grade, drawing plus dictation counts when writing stamina is low.

Report Element	What Student Answers
WHY	Why does this matter in my life, family, citizenship, faith, or stewardship?
WHAT	What are 3 important ideas? Say it in my own words.
HOW	Show the work: read aloud, draw, count, map, act, sing, build, or teach.
WHAT IF	Where else could I use this? What would happen if this idea was missing?
GRIT	Best mistake, what I learned, and one thing I will try next.

5. Grade Mission Map

These mission arcs convert the source curriculum into Strive-style integrated learning. Each arc can become a 1-4 week unit depending on depth, student pace, and family schedule.

#	Mission Arc	Best Integrated Subjects
1	Continents, Countries, and Maps Launch	Reading + Vocabulary + Writing + History/Geography + Logic + Art/Music
2	Mesopotamia River City	Reading + Vocabulary + Writing + History/Geography + Logic + Art/Music
3	Ancient Egypt Pyramid Mission	Reading + Vocabulary + Writing + History/Geography + Logic + Art/Music
4	Three World Religions Respect Lab	Reading + Vocabulary + Writing + History/Geography + Logic + Art/Music
5	Early Civilizations of the Americas	Reading + Vocabulary + Writing + History/Geography + Logic + Art/Music
6	Culture of Mexico Festival	Reading + Vocabulary + Writing + History/Geography + Logic + Art/Music
7	Early Explorers and Settlers	Reading + Vocabulary + Writing + History/Geography + Logic + Art/Music
8	Colonies to Independence	Reading + Vocabulary + Writing + History/Geography + Logic + Art/Music
9	Exploring the West	Reading + Vocabulary + Writing + History/Geography + Logic + Art/Music
10	Lessons in Civics	Reading + Vocabulary + Writing + History/Geography + Logic + Art/Music
11	Habitat Helper Patrol	Reading + Vocabulary + Writing + Science + Logic + Art/Music
12	Ocean Explorer Dock	Reading + Vocabulary + Writing + Science + Logic + Art/Music
13	Body Systems Crew	Reading + Vocabulary + Writing + Science + Logic + Art/Music
14	Germ Defense Lab	Reading + Vocabulary + Writing + Science + Logic + Art/Music
15	Electricity Spark Station	Reading + Vocabulary + Writing + Science + Logic + Art/Music
16	Astronomy Night Watch	Reading + Vocabulary + Writing + Science + Logic + Art/Music

6. Sample Integrated Mission

Mission Theme: Ancient Egypt Pyramid Mission

4MAT Phase	Teacher / Student Move
WHY	Why did people build communities near rivers, and why do old civilizations still matter today?
WHAT	Nile River, desert, pharaohs, pyramids, writing, farming, and daily life.
HOW	Read a short passage twice, map the Nile, build a simple pyramid model, count blocks, and draw symbols.
WHAT IF	Samuel and Pen must design a safe supply route through the desert. What would they need first?
MASTERY	Student names 3 Egypt facts, points to Egypt/Nile on a map, retells the mission, and completes 5 retrieval questions.

7. Mastery, Adaptation, and Intervention Rules

Mastery target: 80-90%. Below that, reteach differently. Above that, extend. The system should adapt; the student should not be blamed for a bad lesson design.

Signal	AI/Mentor Response
Low accuracy	Drop one difficulty level, give one worked example, then retry with fewer items.
Slow completion	Chunk the task, use a timer, reduce visual clutter, and allow oral response.
Repeated error	Teach the misconception directly with contrast examples and a short teach-back.
Low engagement	Switch modality: story, song, drawing, movement, discussion, or build challenge.
Fast mastery	Unlock challenge path, leadership role, extra book, or teach-it drill.
Frustration	Pause, name the obstacle, do one easier win, then return. Grit is trained, not barked into existence.

Grade-Level Mastery Evidence

- Student can retell a story or concept in age-appropriate words.
- Student can complete a visible task: drawing, count, map, oral answer, sentence, song, model, or project artifact.
- Student can remember prior learning after a delay, not only right after being told.
- Student can identify one mistake and one improvement step.
- Student can connect the learning to real life, character, family, citizenship, stewardship, or a practical skill.

8. AI Lesson Generator Input Template

Grade: 1st Grade

Mission theme: [choose one from Grade Mission Map]

Source content: [paste textbook/unit notes]

Target reading level: [student level]

Required outputs: WHY hook, WHAT explanation, HOW activity, WHAT IF challenge, mastery check, 10 vocabulary words, 5 retrieval questions, oral retell prompt, simplified version, challenge version, Mind Palace reflection prompt.

Student supports: ADHD-friendly chunks, dyslexia-friendly passage, autism-friendly clear expectations, optional oral response, visual diagram, movement activity, and hands-on project.

9. Parent / Mentor Weekly Review

Question	Answer Space
What did the student master this week?	
What needs reteaching next week?	
Which modality worked best?	Visual / Audio / Hands-on / Conversation / Reading / Mixed
What character habit improved?	

Question	Answer Space
What is one kaizen change for next week?	